

Adventure Race — Participant Withdrawal SOP

NZ Army Leadership Centre | Army Command School

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1. Purpose

Provide a consistent, fair and defensible process for deciding whether a participant is withdrawn from the Adventure Race for safety, medical, conduct or performance reasons.

2. Governing principle

The Adventure Race deliberately exposes participants and teams to pressure, fatigue, adversity, uncertainty and interpersonal friction in support of approved learning objectives. Withdrawal is justified only where a participant's condition, capability or conduct materially prevents:

- safe participation;
- meaningful individual participation; or
- maintenance of learning and assessment conditions.

3. Grounds for withdrawal

1. **Safety or medical risk** — continued participation is unsafe or breaches an authorised medical restriction.
2. **Physical participation** — the participant cannot safely undertake sufficient required activity despite reasonable adaptation.
3. **Learning and assessment validity** — the participant can no longer be meaningfully exposed to, develop against, or be assessed against approved objectives.
4. **Conduct** — repeated refusal, deliberate non-compliance, or behaviour that creates risk or prevents team functioning after feedback.
5. **Developmental welfare** — continued participation is likely to cause harm and no longer provides meaningful developmental benefit.

4. Not grounds by themselves

Slower pace than peers; need for reasonable assistance; redistribution of equipment; increased workload on others; frustration or interpersonal friction; a need to adjust pace, roles or plan. These are normal developmental effects of the activity.

5. The withdrawal test

What specific safety requirement, required activity, or approved learning or assessment objective can no longer be safely or meaningfully achieved — and what evidence shows that reasonable coaching, team adaptation or authorised adjustment will not restore the necessary conditions?

A slower team, greater workload or frustration alone will not normally meet this threshold.

6. Decision process

1. **Observe and enable** — identify the issue; allow the team a reasonable opportunity to recognise, respond and manage it.
2. **Intervene and reassess** — provide clear feedback; apply authorised adjustments; reassess whether safe and meaningful participation remains achievable.
3. **Decide and record** — if withdrawal remains necessary, staff provide observations and a recommendation to the designated uniformed authority.

For non-immediate withdrawal, CI or SI NZALC and CI NCO School discuss the case; CI NCO School recommends withdrawal to COMDT ACS for confirmation.

Immediate withdrawal. An instructor, safety staff member or medical practitioner may immediately stop or withdraw a participant to manage an immediate safety or medical risk, informing CI NZALC and CI NCO School as soon as practicable.

7. Record of decision

Every withdrawal records:

- the ground for withdrawal and the relevant requirement or objective;
- observed evidence and any medical restriction;
- coaching, adaptations or authorised adjustments attempted;
- why the issue exceeded normal developmental friction;
- who recommended and who confirmed the withdrawal; and
- the effect on assessment and continued course participation.